



UNIVERSITY OF
PLYMOUTH

Enhanced Assessment Brief

PUSL3122

HCI, Computer Graphics, and Visualisation

20 Credit Module

ASSESSMENT: 50% assessment 1 50% assessment 2

Module Leader: Dr. Taimur Bakhshi

MODULE AIMS

- To establish a systematic understanding of the concepts and techniques and good practice of information visualization in the context of HCI principles.
- To design and implement appropriate plans for evaluating the usability of software.
- To develop a systematic understanding of graphics and media applications
- To apply methods and algorithms in the context of computer animation and visualisation

ASSESSED LEARNING OUTCOMES (ALO):

At the end of the module the learner will be expected to be able to:

Assessed Module Learning Outcomes	Award/ Programme Learning Outcomes contributed to
1. Critically evaluate the usability of a small software system and document the user feedback gathered.	BSc (Hons) Computer Science 8.1.1, 8.1.3 8.2.2, 8.2.3, 8.2.4, 8.2.5
2. Design the front-end of a small software system in line with good practice in HCI.	8.3.1, 8.3.2, 8.3.3, 8.3.4, 8.3.5 8.4.3
3. Investigate the principles of graphics and media applications,	8.5.1

Commented [JS1]: An Enhanced Assessment Brief can be used where module information is held on the DLE.

Commented [JS2]: For example: 50% coursework 50% exam - copied from module record

Commented [JS3]: Module Aims and ALO must be copied from the module record

4. Apply standard APIs for the construction of UIs and display of standard media formats.	BSc (Hons) Software Engineering Setting 2; Knowledge & understanding 1,4,5; Cognitive skills 1,2,3,4,5; Performance & practice 1; Personal and enabling skills 1,2,3,4,5,6;
5. Systematically understand theories and techniques related to 2D and 3D rendering and implement a simple real-time renderer using a rasterization API.	BSc (Hons) Data Science 8.1.2, 8.2.2, 8.5.1, 8.5.2,
6. Critically review algorithms for scalar and vector visualization.	

Overview

This document contains all the necessary information pertaining to the assessment of *PUSL3122 HCI, Computer Graphics, and Visualisation*

The sections that follow will detail the assessment tasks that are to be undertaken. The submission and expected feedback dates (witihn 20 working dates of submission) are presented in Table 1. All assessments are to be submitted electronically via the respective DLE module pages before the stated deadlines.

Assessment	Submission Deadline	Feedback
Exam (DLE-based)	May 2026 (TBD)	TBD
Group coursework portfolio	19th March, 2026	3rd April, 2026

Table 1: Assessment Deadlines

All assessments have a deadline of 16:00 SL time (10:30 UK Winter / 11:30 UK Summer).
Please note that work submitted after the deadline of 16:00 SL time will be marked at 0%.

All assessments will be introduced in class to provide further clarity over what is expected and how you can access support and formative feedback prior to submission. Whilst the assessment information is provided at the start of the module, it is not necessarily expected you will start this immediately – as you will often not have sufficient understanding of the topic. The module leader will provide guidance in this respect.

Assessment 1: Test

This test contributes to 50% of the overall module mark for PUSL3122. The form of a test will be an **online exam**, to be completed by students within a **designated time window**, which will be announced in advance.

- **Exam Conditions:** This will be an open-book assessment. Students may consult permitted materials while completing the exam but must work independently and adhere to academic integrity requirements.
- **Exam Format:** The assessment will consist of Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs). The duration will be one hour.
- **Exam Delivery:** The exam will be accessed and completed online via the Digital Learning Environment (DLE). Students will receive a password at the start of their chosen session within the time window.
- **Schedule:** The specific time window and any additional instructions will be communicated by the Admin Team through the official DLE channel and university communications.

Marking criteria/Rubric

Correct, and incorrect (with partial marking for correct answers where more than one answer is required).

Assessment submission details Assessment will be conducted online via DLE module page.

Assessment 2: Portfolio Coursework

This assignment contributes to 50% of the overall module mark for module code. The coursework is conducted as group work and carries 50% of the total module grade.

- **Assignment Details:** Specifics regarding the assignment, expected deliverables, and assessment criteria are available in the Coursework Brief, which is accessible via the module's DLE page.
- **Group Formation:** Students will be assigned to groups by the module team. Details and deadlines for group creation and communication channels will also be provided in the Coursework Brief.
- **Submission:** Final submission must be made via the DLE submission portal by the indicated deadline. Late submissions may be subject to penalties in accordance with institutional policy.

Marking criteria/Rubric :

1. Application (40%)

Mark Band	Descriptor
<30%	Little or no evidence of coding skills in project implementation. Little or no indication of user requirements having been implemented. Little to no indication of any attempt to go beyond the coursework teaching/brief.
30–39%	Poor skills in implementing code; incorrect and/or very confused. User requirements shown as implemented but inconsequential. Inadequate and poorly defined plan for innovation.
40–49%	Some skill in implementing the software, but with errors and/or confusion. Application provides more functionality than login and registration. User requirements shown as implemented but unclear. Plan for innovation vague or largely unjustified.
50–59%	Skill in most areas of software implementation with some issues/errors. Implementation of moderate complexity with suitable functionality. Requirements matched to implementation with some errors/omissions. Relevant features considered; accuracy or clarity could improve.

60–69%	Competent implementation with minor issues/errors. Application has suitable complexity and appropriate architecture (not monolithic; demonstrates interactions between layers). Requirements matched appropriately; meaningful choice of requirements. Logical consideration of innovative features, mostly evidence-based.
70–79%	Highly skilled implementation beyond taught module level. Application shows good complexity and strong software engineering. Requirements clearly indicative of a minimum viable product. Innovations well-presented and justified.
80–100%	Expert level skill evident throughout. Software is of commercial quality and could be deployed with minimal modification. Requirements and implementation are of professional standard. Innovation plan is clear, concise, fully justified, and demonstrates original, proactive development.

2. Design & Testing (40%)

Mark Band	Descriptor
<30%	Project devoid of appropriate testing plan. Little or no indication of requirements. Images/graphs/figures sparse, illegible, or irrelevant.
30–39%	Poor skills in applying testing; incorrect or confused. Requirements present but vague and poorly defined; diagrams not provided. Images/graphs/figures do not convey required information.
40–49%	Some relevant testing applied; V&V superficial or flawed. Requirements present but need more development; diagrams show limited understanding. Most images/graphs/figures convey required information but may lack clarity or contain errors.
50–59%	Appropriate testing in place with some omissions or errors. Requirements presented with appropriate diagrams; some questionable logic. Mainly appropriate images/graphs/figures; aesthetics or labelling could improve.
60–69%	Competent testing plan with appropriate V&V. Requirements clear and sensibly defined; appropriate for project complexity. Most images/graphs/figures of high standard with minor issues.
70–79%	Highly competent testing regime in both plan and implementation; demonstrates understanding beyond taught modules. Requirements have good depth; diagrams clearly derived from requirements. Images/graphs/figures of high standard conveying all required information.
80–100%	Expert testing plans suitable for commercial use. Requirements excellent with little to add; diagrams professional-quality. Creative, high-quality visuals at peer-reviewed journal standard.

3. Approach (20%)

Mark Band	Descriptor
	Writing incomprehensible; inappropriately written work. Little to no indication of any attempt to go beyond coursework brief.
30–39%	Poor literacy. Inadequate and poorly defined plan for innovation.
40–49%	Mainly appropriate writing style but could improve. Plan for innovation vague or largely unjustified.
50–59%	Clear writing and presentation. Relevant features considered; accuracy or clarity could improve.
60–69%	Lucid writing; clear and unambiguous presentation. Logical consideration of innovative features, mostly evidence-based and clearly articulated.
70–79%	Literacy and presentation approaching peer-reviewed standard. Innovations well-presented and well-justified.

80–100%	Professional-level writing. Clear, concise, fully justified innovation plan showing original thinking and proactive development.
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Assessment submission details including file type and link to submission are available in the coursework brief on the DLE module page.

You are required to submit your assessment(s) before the deadline, electronically through Moodle/DLE. See [here](#) for information about online submissions (log-in required)

Assessment Feedback

Feedback on your submitted assessment will be provided within 20 working days from the submission date, via the DLE.

General Guidance

Extenuating Circumstances

There may be a time during this module where you experience a serious situation which has a significant impact on your ability to complete the assessments. The definition of these can be found in the University Policy on Extenuating Circumstances here:

[Extenuating Circumstances Policy and Procedures 2024-25 clean copy.pdf](#)

Academic Offences / Plagiarism and Examination Offences

Academic Offences including plagiarism are treated very seriously by the University.

All of your work must be of your own words. You must use references for your sources, however you acquire them. Where you wish to use quotations, these must be a very minor part of your overall work.

To copy another person's work is viewed as plagiarism and is not allowed. Any issues of plagiarism and any form of academic dishonesty are treated very seriously. All your work must be your own and other sources must be identified as being theirs, not yours. The copying of another persons' work could result in a penalty being invoked.

Further information on plagiarism policy can be found here:

Plagiarism: <https://www.plymouth.ac.uk/student-life/your-studies/essential-information/regulations/plagiarism>

Examination Offences: <https://www.plymouth.ac.uk/student-life/your-studies/essential-information/exams/exam-rules-and-regulations/examination-offences>

Turnitin is an Internet-based 'originality checking tool' which allows documents to be compared with content on the Internet, in journals and in an archive of previously submitted works. It can help to detect unintentional or deliberate plagiarism.

It is a formative tool that makes it easy for students to review their citations and referencing as an aid to learning good academic practice. Turnitin produces an 'originality report' to help guide you. Further information on how the university uses Turnitin for E-submission can be found [here](#) (log-in required).

Draft Coach can be accessed via this link <https://ec.plymouth.ac.uk/turnitin-draft-coach/> and guides students from the first-to-final draft of their assignment using **similarity**, **citation**, and **grammar-checking** tools.

Referencing

The University of Plymouth Library has produced an online support referencing guide which is available here: <http://plymouth.libguides.com/referencing>.

Another recommended referencing resource is [Cite Them Right Online](#); this is an online resource which provides you with specific guidance about how to reference lots of different types of materials.

Academic Skills Development including online support and guidance for referencing can be found here [Academic Skills Development](#) and through the [Student study file](#).

DISCLAIMER

All the information in this Enhanced Assessment Brief is correct at the time of publication. Courses are regularly reviewed and updated so details may change. Information about changes will be posted on the module website so please ensure that you regularly visit the DLE.